For a very long time, the narrative was controlled by those who were in power because the only mediums for that were tax-funded institutions and media houses who depended on the state's largesse for their survival. So, you read and heard what the establishment wanted you to do. India is no exception. Then came the internet. It was disruptive in some ways, but not as disruptive as social media is. Social media is really true, it is the spanner in the works.

Now there are people who have opinions who write about it and it gets shared widely. The most read historians today are amateur historians who actually challenged the more established order or the historic narrative. This is similar to the case with politics. The most credible authors are not the ones who occupy exalted positions and media houses, but the ones who have written comprehensively with truth and facts on their side. This change has happened at different levels. Everybody's not going to the same school. They don't speak the same English. Therefore, sometimes how people in some of these smaller towns express themselves comes across as offensive or comes across as being crass.

Most people who otherwise thought that it was their ordained right to pontificate, now when they get challenged on social media, they ignore the argument and focus on the language. I'm not saying for a minute that that's acceptable, but I'm trying to just tell you that, if I don't like something, there are various ways of saying it. I can say it in Oxford English or I could just use an expletive and express myself. But the point remains that you've been questioned, you're being challenged, your narrative is being challenged. You've been called out.

That's what social media has done. To say that the right is more abusive is complete bunkum. The liberals are more illiberal, more intolerant. They are more abusive, but they are like a bunch of well-knit and a closely knit group of individuals. On the other hand, the right-wing is a more diffused network of very competent, well-meaning well-read individuals who actually have a life. And we have a job to go back to. The leftist are surviving on doles from the state government or languishing in campuses and out on the streets protesting, that's really the difference between the two.